

Shanna Wu

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EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley | College of Letters & Science
Bachelor of Arts, Molecular and Cell Biology

Major GPA: 4.00/4.00
Expected May 2029

PUBLICATIONS

Journal of Pharmacology and Experimental Therapeutics

Second Author

March 2025

Orabueze, O., Wu, S., & Andresen, B. (2025). Inserting part of the $G\alpha_{i1}$ helical domain into $G\alpha_s$ confers RGS interaction with $G\alpha_s$. *Journal of Pharmacology and Experimental Therapeutics*, 392(3), Article 100692. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jpet.2024.100692>

PROFESSIONAL RESEARCH

Western University of Health Sciences

Pomona, CA

Research Assistant

July 2024 – March 2025

- Confirmed $G\alpha_s$ / $G\alpha_{i1}$ chimera (sis) engages RGS4 via co-immunoprecipitation and Western blot, demonstrating that AlF_4^- -activated sis co-immunoprecipitates with RGS4 and linking chimera cycling to GRK inhibition in GPCR signaling
- Modeled $G\alpha_{i1}$ / $G\alpha_s$ /sis–RGS4 binding using 160 ns NAMD simulations, AlphaFold2, and Swiss-Model; identified helix B–helix C salt bridges in sis that produce intermediate RGS4 affinity between $G\alpha_s$ and $G\alpha_{i1}$
- Co-authored peer-reviewed paper in JPET and conference abstract with Dr. Bradley Andresen; presented at ASPET 2025

Pioneer Research Program

Diamond Bar, CA

Research Scholar

June 2024 – Sept 2024

- Computationally designed and evaluated 4 novel succinylcholine derivatives as safer NMBAs using AutoDock, PyMOL, and UCSF Chimera to model receptor-ligand binding affinity and selectivity
- Authored and presented a 15 page full research paper evaluated by academic mentors and Dr. Thomas Bakupog

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Berkeley Skydeck - MiRNDa

Berkeley, CA

Research & Strategy Intern

Nov 2025 – Present

- Synthesized 120+ peer-reviewed oncology papers across 4 cancer types to evaluate clinical translation potential of microRNA-based therapeutics targeting lung, colon, cervical, and liver cancers
- Represented MiRNDa to biotech investors at satellite events during the JPMorgan Healthcare Conference in San Francisco, pitching pre-clinical microRNA therapeutic pipeline

Kidney Disease and Screening Awareness Program (KDSAP)

Berkeley, CA

Clinical Volunteer

Sept 2025 – May 2026

- Supported UCSF physicians in chronic kidney disease risk screening for low-income patients; collected anthropometric data (BMI, waist-to-hip ratio) and facilitated registration and post-screening care discussions
- Coordinated 5 hour screening shifts to assist in early kidney disease risk assessment

Olera

Berkeley, CA

Product & UI/UX Intern

Nov 2025 – Present

- Improved a healthcare SaaS platform used by medical practitioners through user testing, UI debugging, and frontend fixes; presented market sizing and product roadmap at UC Berkeley Launch Accelerator
- Directed outreach with physicians, nutritionists, and dietitians to identify pain points in GLP-1 prescribing workflows

Flexpenser

Solna, Stockholm

Business Investment Associate

June 2026 – Present

- Co-developed pitch materials and supported enterprise client meetings with L'Oréal and Amcor for a biocompatible, preservative-free airtight membrane packaging technology with pharmaceutical applications
- Conducted investor outreach through targeted email campaigns and held 15-minute introductory meetings with prospective investors to communicate company value proposition and explore fundraising opportunities

CERTIFICATIONS

Basic Life Support (BLS), American Heart Association

Orange, CA | Expires: Aug 2027

Medical Ethics, PREMED PROJECTS

Diamond Bar, CA | Apr 2024

ADDITIONAL

Software: PyMOL, Autodock, UCSF Chimera, Microsoft Office (PowerPoint, Excel, Word), Google Suite, Canva

Lab & Research: Micropipeting, Western Blot, Gel Electrophoresis, Bacteria Transformation/PCR, Column Chromatography, DNA Extraction, Lab Sterilization/Safety/Hygiene

Languages: Bilingual proficiency in English and Chinese (California Seal of Biliteracy)

Interests: Immunology, Gene Editing, Drug Development, Protein Signaling, Molecular Therapeutics